



2 UNIT

Character

LESSON 1. Handwriting and personality



Communicative area: describing a personality

Active vocabulary: arrogant, bossy, confident, creative, curious, dishonest, generous, greedy, honest, however, impatient, intelligent, a loner, patient, personality, punctual, reliable, reserved, selfish, selfless, sensitive, sociable, traits, unpunctual, unreliable, witty

1. a. Look at the proverb below. What does it mean? Do you agree with it?

You can't tell a book by its cover.

b. Write the proverb down on a piece of paper. Is your handwriting neat and tidy or messy and unclear?

2. a. Read the entry below and answer the question at the end.



Graphology is the study of handwriting. It's used to analyse a writer's character, personality, abilities, etc. Your handwriting can indicate more than 5,000 different personality traits. So, what are graphologists looking at?

b.  Listen to the programme about graphology and follow in the book. Check your answer.

So, what do graphologists look at?

Size

Large letters: You are active, cheerful and **witty**, enjoy sharing a joke and have a great sense of humour. You are very **confident**, which means you always know what you are doing.

Average letters: You are **reserved** and can hide your feelings. On the other hand, you can sometimes appear cold and unfriendly.

Small letters: You are shy and **sensitive**; you can be easily hurt.

Spacing between words

Wide spacing: You are **independent**, enjoy your freedom and don't like control as well. However, people often think you are **arrogant**, that you believe you are better and more important than others.

Narrow spacing: You are talkative and **sociable**; you enjoy being with other people. On the other hand, you tend to be **bossy** and often tell other people what to do.

Slanting

No slant: You are **punctual** and **honest**; you usually come on time and always tell the truth.

Slants to the right: You are adventurous, you have a brave heart and ready to take risks.

Slants to the left: You work better behind the scenes. You are a bit of a **loner** – prefer being alone to spending time with other people.

Shape of letters

Rounded letters: You are kind and **generous**, you share and give more than people expect. You are also artistic and **creative**. You have a great imagination and enjoy inventing new words, things and stories.

Pointed letters: You are very intelligent and **curious**, you like learning new things. However, you can be a little **nosy** – too interested in what other people are doing. You can sometimes be **greedy**, and it means you don't like sharing your things, ideas or space.

Writing pressure

Heavy pressure: People trust you, because you are very **reliable**, you never break a promise. On the other hand, you tend to be **stubborn** and never change your opinion, even if you are not right.

Light pressure: You are helpful and **selfless**, you care about other people's interests.

Writing speed

If you write quickly: You are often **impatient**, dislike waiting or time wasters. In addition, you can often be loud and emotional.

If you write slowly: You are well-organised, careful and **patient**. You can wait to get a result. It can also mean you are a bit lazy and don't like hard work.

3. a. Read the text and explain the words in bold.

b. Find more adjectives in the text that describe personality traits.

c. Find antonyms to the adjectives below. Write them down in pairs.

Dishonest, friendly, greedy, lazy, patient, quiet, selfish, shy, sociable, talkative, unpunctual, unreliable

Example: lazy – active, ...

d. Study the sentences. What words are used to soften negative personality traits? Why is it important to use them?

1. You can be a little nosy. 2. You are often impatient. 3. You can sometimes appear cold and unfriendly. 4. You tend to be bossy.

4.  Work in pairs. Exchange the strips of paper with the proverb. Discuss what your handwriting says about you. Do you agree with the results? Why (not)? Share with the class.

5. a. Find the words below in the text. Which of them are used to link positive and negative ideas?



On the other hand / In addition / Also / However / As well

b. Use the words above to link the ideas.

1. My mum is very intelligent. Sometimes she tends to be bossy.

2. We are a friendly, sociable family. We are very talkative and emotional.

3. I am really curious. I can be nosy.

4. My little brother is active and witty. He can be stubborn and naughty.

5. My grandparents are loving and patient. They can be forgetful at times.

6. a.  Write some sentences about your personality traits on a piece of paper. Use the linkers to join the ideas.

b. Work as a class. Collect and mix your papers. Read out your descriptions in turns. Can you guess who they belong to?

LESSON 2. What are you like?



Communicative area: asking questions about one's character

Active vocabulary: compound adjectives: absent-minded, easy-going, kind-hearted, open-minded, quick-witted, self-centred, thin-skinned

1. Work as a class. Brainstorm as many personality adjectives as possible. Who is the last to name an adjective?

2. a.  Listen to three people answer a survey question. What is the question?

b. Check your memory. Who said the following: Tanya, Louis or Jacob?

1. We also tend to be self-centred and a bit absent-minded when it comes to other people's needs.

2. We are both short, dark-haired, and a little overweight.

3. My mum is more thin-skinned and she is quiet too.

4. She is really hard-working and a bit stubborn at times.

5. I took after my dad because I am more of an open-minded, easy-going person just like him.

6. He is tall and skinny, blue-eyed, just like me.

7. We are quick-witted and love a good joke.

c.  Listen again and check your answers.

3. a. Read about compound adjectives. Find compound adjectives in the sentences above and write them down.



A **compound adjective** is an adjective that contains two or more words. Usually, a hyphen “-” (or hyphens) is used to link the words together to show that it is one adjective.

b.  Discuss the meaning of the adjectives in your list in pairs.

4. Match the compound adjectives below to their form.

1. number + noun

2. adjective +

Past Participle

3. noun + adjective

4. noun + Present Participle
(-ing)

5. noun + Past Participle

6. number + noun +
adjective

7. adverb + Past Participle

a) **kind-hearted** person

b) **well-known** actress

c) **record-breaking** show

d) **9-year-old** girl

e) **middle-aged** man

f) **three-week** holiday

g) **world-famous** writer

5.  Discuss the questions below in pairs.

1. How are the adjectives in your list formed?
2. Which of these adjectives describe you?
3. Which adjectives describe someone in your family?

6. a. You are a blogger. Walk around the class and role play the street interview. Use the questions below to collect the information. Take notes.

1. Who do you take after?
2. What does he / she look like?
3. What kind of person is he / she?

b. Report on your findings.

LESSON 3. I used to be a river



Communicative area: speaking about changes

Active vocabulary: *used to*

Active grammar: *used to* + infinitive (affirmative and negative statements)

1. Complete the sentence below about yourself and share with the class.

When I was younger, I...

Example: When I was younger, I was much more curious. I loved exploring nature.

2. a. Look through the e-mail letter Yan got from his friend. Who are the kids in the photographs?

Hi, Yan! I hope you've found the photo album and everything is ok with your school project. The photograph I'm sending was taken four years ago. Of course, we look very different today, but I haven't changed much. As you can



see, I used to have longer hair, but I've had it short since my 10th birthday. I think I used to look shy, but now I'm much more confident.

Rosie has changed a lot! She used to be short and fat. Now she looks much fitter. Her hair used to be curly and she used to have it shoulder-length and now it's longer. And she didn't use to have freckles, too. She used to be a quiet little girl and behave really well. She was so caring and selfless, she used to make sandwiches for me! However, two years ago, after she took up hockey, things have changed. Now she's self-centred and bossy, in addition, she is telling me to make sandwiches for her! She used to be an ideal sister –



easy-going and fun, but now she's really arrogant, she acts like a know-it-all. We used to go roller-skating and watch horror films together. All she can talk about now is boys and shopping. And she's only 10!

Read the philosophical poem I've written. What do you think about it?

I used to be a river, but now I'm an ocean.
I used to be letters, but now I'm a poem.
I used to be greedy, but now I have a heart of gold.
I used to be shy, but now I am self-confident.
I used to have a sister, but now I have a boss.
She used to be a dolphin, but now she's a shark.

P.S. The second picture is Rosie now. Bye. Nick

b.  Look at the letter again and answer the questions below.

1. Did Nick have longer hair when he was younger? Does he have it long now? 2. Was Rosie short and fat? Is she short and fat now? 3. Did Rosie have freckles when she was little? Does she have them now? 4. Was

Rosie self-centred and bossy in the past? Is she bossy now? 5. Does *used to* mean *something that happened in the past* or *something that is still true*? 6. How do you translate *used to* into your language? 7. How do you make a negative sentence with *used to*?

3.  **Work in pairs. Find sentences with *used to* / *didn't use to* in Nick's letter. Are any of them true for you?**

4. Look at the box and write the sentences with *used to* or *didn't use to*.



used to + infinitive; didn't use to + infinitive

Example: *We lived in Minsk. Now we live in Polotsk.*
– *We used to live in Minsk.*

1. I wasn't a sociable child. Now I have many friends. 2. My elder brother has grown a moustache. 3. My granny took up karate a year ago. 4. I've got suntanned, so I don't look pale now. 5. I resembled my dad as a baby, however now I don't look like him at all. 6. My sister was really unpunctual. She always comes on time now. 7. I saw an alien last night. Now I believe in aliens. 8. My dad is bald now.

5. a. Read Nick's philosophical poem again. Write at least one sentence about changes. Use your imagination.

Example: *I used to be a tree, but now I'm a forest.*

b. Put all your sentences together and write them on the board. Read the poem.

LESSON 4. Did you use to...?



Communicative area: asking and answering questions about past habits

Active grammar: *used to* + infinitive (questions)

1. Read the information about a TV programme below. Do you have a programme like that in your country? Have you ever watched it?



The X Factor is a British television talent show, in which people who want to be singers compete for a recording contract and a money prize. It is one of the most popular shows on British television and all over the world. Today there have been about 200 winners of The X Factor in more than 50 countries worldwide.

2. a. 👤👤 At the age of 19 Adam Keating won the X Factor. Speak in pairs. How do you think his life has changed? Use *used to* to speak about the changes.



Example: I think he didn't use to have so many fans.

b. 🎧 Listen to an excerpt from the interview and check your predictions.

c. 🎧 Listen again and correct the false statements below.

1. Adam used to sleep less. 2. He didn't use to be reserved. 3. He used to have many interviews. 4. He didn't use to have short hair. 5. Adam used to look

fitter. 6. He didn't use to go to gym. 7. He used to sing pop-songs. 8. He used to play the guitar.

d.  Work in pairs. Discuss the changes in Adam's life. What changes are positive and what are negative?

3. Check your memory. Complete the questions from the interview.

... you ... look different? ... you ... sing different songs?

4. Use the ideas below to write questions with **used to.**

Example: Where / go? – Where did you use to go?

1. What games / play? 2. What hobby / have?
3. What / look like? 4. What clothes / wear? 5. Where / live?
6. What sports / do? 7. What time / go to bed?
8. What pets / have? 9. What food / dislike?
10. What / be afraid of?

5. a.  Choose five questions from ex. 4 to ask your partner about his / her childhood.

b.  Work in pairs. Ask and answer the questions in turns. Copy the chart and take notes on your partner's answers.

Name: <u>Artyom</u>	
6 years old	Now
used to play with Lego bricks ...	now plays Brawl Stars ...

c. Use your notes to speak about your partner.

Example: When Artyom was 6, he used to play with Lego bricks, and now he plays Brawl Stars.

LESSON 5. Question time



Communicative area: asking questions about the past

Active grammar: *used to* + infinitive (affirmative and negative statements, questions)

1. a. Who could say the following?

1. I used to be a shy kid like you, now I can climb skyscrapers. 2. I have always been curious; however, I didn't use to talk to caterpillars. 3. I used to be selfless and listen to my stepmother, but since I got married, I don't have to listen to her anymore.



b. What would these characters say using *used to* / *didn't use to*? Choose five characters to write the statements.

Spiderman, Jack Sparrow, Cruella, Tom Sawyer, Harry Potter, Shrek, Alice, Darth Vader, Robinson Crusoe, Pocahontas, Sherlock Holmes, Cinderella, Captain America, Hermione Granger, Greg Heffley, Mowgli, Groot, Pippi Longstocking



c. Read out your statements to your partner. Can they guess the character?

2. Which of the statements below are false? Correct them.

1. If we say we *used to do something* in the past, it means we still enjoy doing it.

2. If we say we *didn't use to do something*, it means we didn't do something in the past, but probably do it now.

3. We use *did you use to + infinitive* to ask about actions in the past that don't happen anymore.

3. Make sentences using the correct form of **used to**.

1. you / ride a bike with training wheels? 2. She / be so nosy, now she wants to know everything. 3. She / resemble her mother, however now she looks like her granny on the father's side. 4. you / wear a fringe before you had this haircut? 5. Nick / be my best friend, but he lives in Canada now. 6. I / be a reliable person, but I've been so absent-minded since I fell in love. 7. My dad / go to a barber shop every month, but now he is bald. 8. I / be so skinny, now I weigh 3 kilos less than I should.

4. a.  You are going to play *Find someone who* game. What question will you ask if you need to find someone who used to be a greedy child?

b. What will a person answer if...

1. they were greedy and never shared their toys at the age of 5? 2. they were generous as a child, but now they hate to share? 3. they've never been greedy? 4. they have always been greedy?

5. a.  Write the questions you are going to ask your groupmates. You need to find someone...

1. whose sister used to be chubby as a baby; 2. who used to be dishonest and lied a lot as a child; 3. who used to dislike their appearance; 4. who used to be a loner in elementary school; 5. who used to have an unreliable friend; 6. who used to have fair hair as a baby; 7. who used to watch Peppa Pig cartoon. 8. who used to wear braces.

b. What mistake do people often make asking questions with **used to**? Check your questions for this mistake.

c.  Walk around and ask the questions you have written. Take notes.

d. Report to the class.

LESSON 6. Life in the past



Communicative area: speaking about life in the past

Active vocabulary: imaginative

1. Was life 100 years ago different from life today? What did (didn't) people use to have? What did they use to do?

Example: People didn't use to have washing machines.

2. a. Look at these objects from the past. What are they? What do you know about them?



1



2



3

b.  Listen to children speaking to their grandmother and check your ideas. Are her memories happy or unhappy?

c. Complete the dialogue using **used to** or **didn't use to**.

– Hey, Gran. Can you tell us about your life in the past? Was it hard?

– Young people always think that life (1. ...) be very hard. But it was not bad really, it was just different. And in many ways life was better in the past. For example, when I was a girl, most people (2. ...) lock their doors. We didn't have anything to steal, so it wasn't a problem.

– Did you have a TV?

– Yes, we did. However, I (3. ...) watch much TV. We (4. ...) have three TV channels that had cartoons once a day on the Good Night Show.

– What did you do in your free time?

– I (5. ...) play outside all day long. Children (6. ...) play in the streets. They can't do this now in most places because everyone's got a car, so there's too much traffic and it's dangerous. Today's children spend all their time indoors.

– Did you have any toys?

– Yes, I (7. ...) play with dolls and plush toys. I had a plush puppy I called Lily. Kids were a bit more imaginative in those days. We didn't have Lego or Barbies, but we played with cards, stones, buttons, we made dolls out of flowers and houses with chairs and blankets.

– Wasn't life boring without video games?

– Of course, we didn't have a lot of the things that we have today, like computers or mobile phones. Life (8. ...) be much slower and simpler. People were far more easy-going, they (9. ...) rush around like they do today. The best thing about the time when I was young was that people were more sociable. People (10. ...) spend more time together.

– Did you use to travel by horses?

– Of course, not. We (11. ...) have horses, because my grandparents lived on a farm, however we (12. ...)

travel by them. We had cars and buses and planes. I am not that old!

d.  Listen again and check.

3. a. What personality traits does grandma use to describe the people in the past? How different are people today in her opinion? Do you agree?

b. Compare people in the past with people today. Explain your opinion.

Were people in the past more or less...
adventurous, greedy, hard-working, intelligent,
polite, punctual, selfish, unsociable?

4. Look at the dates some things appeared. What did / didn't people in the past use to do?

1. personal computer – 1971;
2. mobile hand-held phone – 1984;
3. Internet – 1989;
4. online shopping – 1995;
5. first Harry Potter book – 1997;
6. YouTube – 2005;
7. TikTok – 2016.

5.  Work in pairs. Continue the dialogue in ex. 2c. Then role-play it.

LESSON 7. Dog people vs cat people



Communicative area: describing a personality

Active vocabulary: cheerful, an extrovert, an introvert, loyal, responsible

1. Discuss the questions below.

1. Do you have a pet? What is it? What is it like?
2. Did you use to have other pets?
3. Who chose your pets? What pet would you like to have? Why?
4. Do you think pets resemble their owners?



2. a. Read the article and choose the correct title.

A. Pets, pets everywhere: the world's most popular pets

B. The truth about cat people and dog people

C. Cats vs dogs: which does the world prefer?

To some people, dogs are the perfect pets. Loyal, loving, playful friends that make your life happier and healthier. To others, dogs are noisy and needy creatures that take all your time either begging for food or taking over your bed. Some people see cats as intelligent, elegant, calming companions, that can take care of their own exercise and cleaning. To others, they are arrogant, uncaring and selfish.

So it's no wonder the scientists have found a link between some personality traits and the type of pet owned.

A 2018 study at the University of Texas found that those who were identified as “dog people” tended to be more active and easy-going, whereas “cat people” tended to be more open-minded: meaning curious, imaginative and creative.

The study found that dog people prefer to plan in advance, they are punctual and reliable. They also tend to follow rules closely. On the other hand, cat owners – who can leave their pets alone for longer periods – are a bit more relaxed when it comes to planning ahead, and are more independent and adventurous.

Cat owners tend to experience more negative emotions than dog owners. According to studies, those who own cats are more thin-skinned. Dog owners are much more thick-skinned and patient.

The recent Facebook survey of 160,000 users, has also found that pets are closely related to the personality of their owners. Most cat owners are introverts, living in big cities, and spending most of their leisure time indoors, watching movies, TV, and reading. Most dog owners are extroverts, they are more sociable and cheerful, with an average of 26 friends more than cat owners.

In addition, dog people are also more selfless. They are generous and kind-hearted. Those who love cats, on the other hand, are more self-centred and arrogant at times.

“Well, let’s talk about the common traits too,” says the survey author and psychologist Sam Gosling, PhD, “Most pet owners are caring and responsible”. He also adds that the differences between cat and dog people aren’t huge. “There are certainly many, many cat people who are extroverts and many, many dog people who aren’t,” Gosling says.

b. Are the sentences true or false according to the article? Find the sentences in the text that prove your ideas.

1. Dogs can make your life better.
2. More people prefer cats to dogs because cats are intelligent, elegant and calming.

3. Cats need less attention than dogs.
4. Dog owners are better-organised in contrast to cat people.
5. Dog people are more cheerful than cat people.
6. These characteristics are not always true.

3. a. Copy the chart. Fill it in with the adjectives from the article that describe personality traits.

Dogs: ...	Cats: ...
Dog owners: ...	Cat owners: ...

b.  Analyse the chart in pairs. Do pet owners and their pets have identical personalities?

4. Discuss the questions.

1. What common traits do cat and dog owners have?
2. What does it mean to be a responsible pet owner?
Are you a responsible pet owner?
3. What are the personal traits of an extrovert?
What are the qualities of an introvert? Do you agree that dogs are more extroverted than cats? What other pets are extroverts?
4. Why do you think dogs are so loyal to people?
Why are cats so independent?

5. a.  Listen to Martha speaking about her aunt. In your chart tick the personal traits she mentions.

b. In your opinion, is aunt Teresa a cat person or a dog person? Why?

6. Speak about your character traits. Let your classmates guess what animal could make a perfect pet for you.

LESSON 8. The person I admire



Communicative area: describing a personality, writing a descriptive essay

1. What can you speak about when you want to describe a person? Write down your ideas.

2. a. Read a student's descriptive essay about her grandfather. Is her description complete?

The person I admire is my grandfather. He is in his early seventies. He looks like Santa Claus. He is tall. He has white hair, many wrinkles and a cheerful smile. He is very generous and witty. I like his jokes. He used to be an actor, but now he works as a bus driver. He is also very stubborn. My mum says I take after him. I love him very much.



b. What do you think the teacher's comments will be? How could you make the description better?

c. Read the teacher's comments on this description. Did you have the same ideas?

You could improve your essay by:

- organising your essay by paragraphs;
- linking short sentences to make longer ones;
- illustrating some of your sentences with examples.

You could also add more details: What makes your grandpa look like Santa Claus? In what way is your grandpa generous? What does he like or dislike about

his job? What are his interests? In what way do you take after your grandpa? What do you do together?

3.  Work in pairs. How would you change the description following the teacher's comments?

4. a. Think of a family member you admire and complete the sentences below about him or her.

1. One of the first things you notice about him / her is ... 2. He / She looks ... 3. The reason I admire him / her is ... 4. He / She is always ... 5. In addition, ... 6. I admire the way he / she ... 7. On the other hand, ... 8. In conclusion, ... 9. Thanks to him / her I ...

b.  Exchange the sentences with your partner. Correct the mistakes if necessary and choose the most interesting sentence.

5. Read the paragraph plan below. In which paragraphs will you write the sentences from ex. 4a?



Introduction:

Paragraph 1: Say who you are writing about. Give background information.

Main body:

Paragraph 2: Describe the person's age and appearance.

Paragraph 3: Write about the person's character. Illustrate some traits with examples. Add more information about his / her interests.

Conclusion:

Paragraph 4: Write what this person makes you feel like, in what way he/she changes your life.

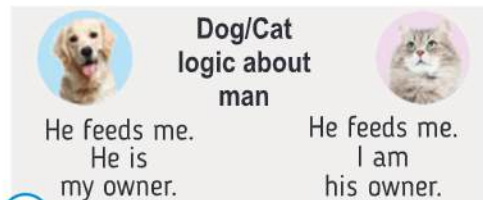
6.   Write your descriptive essay. Use your notes and the plan above.

LESSON 9. Game time!



Communicative area: speaking about the past, describing personalities

1. a. **Work in pairs. Look at the jokes below.**



b. What lessons in this unit could they illustrate?

2. **You are going to play a boardgame in groups of three. Read the rules. What happens if you don't know what to say?**



1. You need a dice and three counters.
2. Players take it in turns to roll the dice and move their counter along the board.
3. When a player lands on a square and has a question to answer or a task to do, he / she has to speak for 30 seconds.
4. If a player is stuck, students ask follow-up questions.
5. The first student to reach the finish square wins the game.

3. Did you learn any interesting information about your groupmates? Share with the class.